

Xgeva (denosumab)

Original Effective Date: 10/04/2021

Revision Date(s): 10/04/2021; 10/04/2023; 4/25/2024; 10/1/2025; 1/1/2026; 4/1/2026

Review Date: 4/1/2026

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 12 (twelve) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan, or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety, and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Preferred	No	Zoledronic Acid (Zometa)	J3489	Injection, zoledronic acid, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab (Xgeva)	J0897	Injection, denosumab, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-desu (Jubereq)	J3590	Unclassified Biologics
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-qbde (Xtrenbo)	J3590	Unclassified Biologics
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-bbdz (Wyost)	Q5136	Injection, denosumab-bbdz (jubbonti/wyost), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-bmwo (Osenvelt)	Q5157	Injection, denosumab-bmwo (stoboclo/osenvelt), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-bmwo (Denosumab-Celtrion)	Q5157	Injection, denosumab-bmwo (stoboclo/osenvelt), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-bnht (Bomynta)	Q5158	Injection, denosumab-bmwo, (stoboclo/osenvelt), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-bnht (denosumab Frensenius)	Q5158	Injection, denosumab-bnht (bomynta/conexence), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-dssb (Xbryk)	Q5159	Injection, denosumab-dssb (ospomyv/xbryk), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-dssb (Denosumab Samsung Bioepis)	Q5159	Injection, denosumab-dssb (ospomyv/xbryk), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-kyqq (Aukelso)	Q5161	Injection, denosumab-kyqq (aukelso/bosaya), biosimilar, 1 mg
Non-Preferred**	Yes	Denosumab-nxxp (Bilprevda)	Q5162	Injection, denosumab-nxxp (bilydos/bilprevda), biosimilar, 1 mg

**Does not apply in the setting of Prostate or Breast Cancer.

- Members must have documentation of contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to new starts only.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Criteria applicable to all requests:

- The member will be monitored and supplemented as needed to prevent hypocalcemia; AND
- The member will not receive denosumab in combination with bisphosphonate therapy

Indication Specific Criteria:

Hypercalcemia of malignancy

- The member has hypercalcemia of malignancy; AND
- The member has an albumin-corrected calcium greater than 12.5 mg/dL

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
 - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association; Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal

of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;

- **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

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Denosumab-deesu (Jubereg)	J3590	Unclassified biologics
Denosumab-nxxp (Bilprevda)	Q5162	Injection, denosumab-nxxp (bilyos/bilprevda), biosimilar, 1 mg
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Denosumab-bbdz (Wyost)	Q5136	Injection, denosumab-bbdz (jubbonti/wyost), biosimilar, 1 mg
Denosumab-bmwo (Osenvelt)	Q5157	Injection, denosumab-bmwo (stoboclo/osenvelt), biosimilar, 1 mg
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Zoledronic Acid (Zometa)	J3489	Injection, zoledronic acid, 1 mg
Denosumab-dssb (Denosumab Samsung Bioepis)	Q5159	Injection, denosumab-dssb (ospomyv/xbryk), biosimilar, 1 mg

References

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13. Referenced with permission from the NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®). National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2026. All rights reserved. Accessed, March 10, 2026. To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NCCN.org.
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Revision History

Date	Updates
5/2/2022	Added preferred products and recommended step-therapy options. Added monitoring of Vitamin D and Calcium per FDA/prescribing information. Added to not be given concurrently with bisphosphonate therapy as per NCCN. Added Albumin corrected calcium calculation Added language regarding intolerance and contraindication to bisphosphonate therapy as per NCCN
07/28/2022	Removed System Mastocytosis as per scope
10/2/2023	Addition of step therapy
4/25/2024	Annual review; Update step therapy table formatting, Universal Criteria, References
10/01/2025	Annual review, template update; <i>approved by OH P&T</i>
10/23/2025	Policy adopted by GEHA; document updated for universal accessibility.
1/1/2026	Added Aukelso, Denosumab Celltrion, Bilprevda, Xtrenbo, Wyost; Addition of Juberea (denosumab-desu) – J3590
4/1/2026	Addition of Denosumab Samsung Bioepis (denosumab-dssb) Q5159; update HCPCS for Aukelso (Q5161), Bilprevda (Q5162)